



Minion Me Service Marketplace Project Proposal

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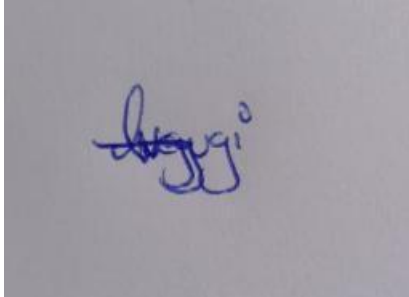
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Declaration

I hereby declare that this project proposal is my original work and has not been submitted elsewhere.

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to be 'H. J. J.', is centered on a light gray rectangular background.

5th November 2025.

1. Background

The dynamic services sector in Kenya, encompassing essential tasks like errands, household assistance, delivery, and manual labour, is largely managed through informal word-of-mouth and unstructured social media channels. This reliance on non-verified, decentralized networks introduces systemic inefficiencies, creates critical security risks, and undermines accountability for both clients and service providers. This deficiency hinders economic formalization and trust within a gig market poised for rapid growth.

Minion Me is a proposed digital marketplace designed to formalize and digitize this essential service economy. While inspired by global models, Minion Me is critically localized to the Kenyan socio-economic context. The platform's core strength lies in its ability to directly address the trust deficit by integrating robust security vetting and essential local features, such as seamless Mobile Money payment integration (e.g., M-Pesa) and a mobile-first interface. By providing a structured, verified, and transparent service environment, Minion Me will unlock economic opportunity, offering providers reliable income access and offering clients unparalleled safety, convenience, and standardized service delivery.

2. Problem Statement

The informal nature of Kenya's on-demand service and gig market creates significant systemic friction. Clients, whether individuals or small businesses, consistently struggle to find reliable, verified assistance for small-scale or short-term tasks quickly.

Current alternatives, which predominantly rely on personal contacts, informal brokers, or unstructured digital communities like WhatsApp groups, are inherently deficient. They lack the necessary framework for security, traceability, transparent pricing, and professional standards. This deficiency exposes both clients and providers to avoidable risk and inefficiency.

Crucially, service providers equally lack a structured, formal avenue to advertise their skills, secure consistent income, and build a verifiable digital work reputation. This dual market failure results in lost time, pervasive mistrust throughout the service ecosystem, underutilization of local talent, and suppressed employment opportunities.

There is a clear and urgent need for a secure, efficient, and locally optimized digital platform that formalizes this economy and effectively bridges this critical service gap.

3. Proposed Solution

The proposed solution is the development of **Minion Me**, a robust and locally optimized **web-based digital marketplace** designed to bridge the trust and efficiency gaps in Kenya's informal service sector.

Minion Me will provide a secure, structured platform allowing clients to post specific on-demand tasks and swiftly match with pre-vetted service providers, referred to as "Minions."

Minion Me is fundamentally engineered for the Kenyan context, ensuring immediate adoption and trust by focusing on key localized and security features:

- **User Vetting and Security:** Mandatory user registration with **identity verification** to establish trust and accountability. Service providers will feature comprehensive profiles highlighting their skills, work history, and a community-driven **ratings and review system**.
- **Structured Task Management:** An efficient system for **task posting**, allowing providers to engage through bidding or fixed-price assignments, ensuring **price transparency** for clients.
- **Localized Payment Integration:** Seamless and secure integration with **Mobile Money payment systems** (e.g., M-Pesa) for instant, traceable transactions, eliminating the risks associated with cash payments.
- **Real-Time Accountability:** Implementation of **real-time notifications** and an in-platform **progress tracking system** to monitor service delivery from assignment to completion.

Ultimately, Minion Me will move beyond merely digitizing manual processes. It will fundamentally improve the service ecosystem by instilling **security, accountability, convenience**, and providing formal, verifiable earning and reputation-building opportunities for skilled and unskilled local workers.

4. Objectives

Main Objective

To successfully develop and deploy Minion Me, a highly secure and localized digital service marketplace that efficiently connects Kenyan clients with vetted, task-based local service providers, thereby formalizing and professionalizing the on-demand gig economy.

Specific Objectives

The successful execution of the project will involve achieving the following specific goals:

1. **Market Analysis and Strategy:** Conduct a comprehensive analysis of the existing informal service market to identify critical pain points and define the optimal user experience (**UX**) strategy for both service seekers and providers.
2. **Platform Development & Localization:** Design, implement, and launch a fully functional, **mobile-first web platform** featuring structured task posting, assignment, and real-time progress tracking capabilities.
3. **Security and Trust Implementation:** Integrate robust **verification and secure authentication protocols** for all users, alongside seamless and secure **Mobile Money payment integration** (e.g., M-Pesa).
4. **Accountability Framework:** Establish and launch a transparent **rating and review system** that accurately reflects provider performance and client satisfaction, fostering trust and accountability within the community.

5. **Testing and Evaluation:** Conduct rigorous usability testing and collect data on user satisfaction and system performance metrics (e.g., matching speed, successful transaction rates) upon initial deployment to ensure the platform meets its **efficiency and security standards**.

4.1 Literature Review

The development of digital marketplaces represents a significant evolution in commerce, driven by the expansion of internet-based platforms that streamline the peer-to-peer exchange of services. Global exemplars, including TaskRabbit, Fiverr, and Upwork, have established viable models demonstrating how digital infrastructure can effectively manage and scale gig-based economies, offering flexibility and access to services globally.

In Kenya, the local context presents a compelling need for such platforms. The country is characterized by a rapidly expanding gig economy, fueled by high youth unemployment rates and high rates of smartphone and mobile internet penetration. While the need is clear, current local attempts, such as Lynk and Jumia Services, have often focused on niche categories or commercial products, leaving a significant gap in the market for a broad, general task-based service marketplace.

Studies on the efficacy and adoption of service marketplaces consistently identify trust, convenience, and accessibility as critical success factors. Furthermore, research by organizations like the International Labour Organization (ILO) underscores the transformative potential of digital labour platforms: they can effectively formalize informal work, improve labour transparency, and protect workers' rights, provided robust mechanisms for verification, accountability, and secure payment are rigorously enforced.

The Minion Me project is designed to build directly upon these established principles. By focusing on integrating secure identity verification, leveraging the ubiquity of Mobile Money systems (a critical local accessibility factor), and enforcing rigorous accountability mechanisms, the platform aims to create a secure, scalable, and locally optimized digital solution suitable for the Kenyan market.

5. Methodology

The project will adopt the Systems Development Life Cycle (SDLC) approach, a structured methodology that guides systematic software development through distinct, sequential phases. This ensures thorough analysis, planning, and testing at every stage to deliver a robust and well-documented system.

5.1 Requirement Analysis

This initial phase is critical for defining the precise scope and specifications of the Minion Me platform. It involves systematically collecting detailed user and system requirements through targeted methods, including stakeholder interviews, structured surveys, and comparative market observation within the Kenyan context.

Key outcomes of this analysis will include:

- **User Role Definition:** Clearly identifying and documenting the needs, motivations, and journey maps for both primary user groups: **Clients** (service seekers) and **Service Providers** ("Minions").
- **Functional Requirements:** Defining all necessary platform functionalities, such as robust **task creation and assignment workflows**, secure **Mobile Money payment integration**, and the **user verification** lifecycle.
- **Non-Functional Requirements:** Specifying critical quality attributes, including system performance, system security (e.g., data encryption and secure authentication), **usability** (focusing on the mobile-first experience), and **scalability** to handle expected future growth.

This thorough analysis ensures that the subsequent design and development phases are precisely aligned with market demand, local practices, and the core objective of establishing a secure, trust-based marketplace.

5.2 System Design

In this phase, both the logical and physical designs of the system will be created. Logical design will include database schema, data flow diagrams (DFDs), and system architecture diagrams. Physical design will outline the interface layouts, workflows, and data structures.

5.3 System Development

The actual coding and implementation of the system components will take place here. Technologies such as React for the frontend, Node.js for the backend, and MySQL for the database will be used. The platform will be designed to be responsive and user-friendly.

5.4 Testing

This phase will involve functional, usability, and security testing. Functional testing ensures that all modules perform as intended. Usability testing checks the interface's simplicity and user experience, while security testing ensures protection against unauthorized access and data breaches.

5.5 Implementation

Once tested, the system will be deployed to a live server for public access. Training and documentation will be provided to users, and a pilot rollout will be conducted to collect early feedback.

5.6 Maintenance

This final phase involves continuous monitoring, bug fixing, and the addition of new features as required. Maintenance ensures the platform remains secure, reliable, and up to date with user needs and technological trends.

6. Budget and Resources

Item	Description	Expected Cost (KSh)	Actual Cost (KSh)
Hardware	Laptop/computer for development	80,000	0
Software	Development tools and licenses (mostly open source)	5,000	
Internet	Connectivity for research and testing	5,000	
Miscellaneous	Printing, documentation, contingency	5,000	
Total		15,000	

7. Project Schedule

Task No.	Description	Task Hrs	Subtask	Subtask Hrs	Planned Start Date	Actual start date	Planned Completion Date	Actual Completion Date	Deliverables
1	Ideation	12	Concept Development	6	25/10/2025	12/11/2025	01/11/2025	05/11/2025	Problem definition, Initial Concept notes
2	Proposal Writing	20	Drafting & Review	20	26/10/2025	13/11/2025	02/11/2025	15/11/2025	Final Proposal Document
3	Requirements Gathering	40	Interviews and Surveys	20	17/11/2025	18/11/2025	05/12/2025		Requirements Specification Report
4	System Design	60	Database & System Architecture	25	06/12/2025		20/12/2025		DFDs, ER Diagrams, UI Mockups
5	Development	160	Frontend & Backend Development	80	10/01/2026		10/03/2026		Fully Working Prototype
6	Testing	60	Functional & Security testing	25	11/03/2026		25/03/2026		Test Report
7	Implementation	40	Deployment & User Training	20	26/03/2026		05/04/2026		Deployed System
8	Maintenance	30	Debugging & Updates	15	06/04/2026		20/04/2026		Final Report

References

The following sources were used to establish the market context, academic methodology, and operational models guiding the **Minion Me** project proposal:

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